

TINGTINGUOUTOURS4FUNEDIT

Travel Radio Australia and we're broadcasting from Brisbane and I have Tingting Guo and she's from a fantastic company based in Seattle and Los Angeles called Tours for Fun. Now that's Tours the number four and fun. Tingting welcome to the program.

Thank you Jeffrey it's great to be here. And welcome to Australia it's your first time to Australia and tell us a bit about your first impressions when you flew in from from Seattle. Well it took me a while to get here though it's a long journey.

I flew from Seattle to Los Angeles from Los Angeles to Fiji from Fiji to here so when I was landing I saw the blue ocean and the land the coastline is amazing absolutely stunning and then when I land I think my first impression is I was talking to some gentleman at the airport it's a humor of the Aussies I think you guys have a great sense of humor and really like it. Well we're very friendly and very welcoming to foreigners and people who come to visit us here and I suppose you would also notice that the the country is very clean and organized and that sort of thing. Yes absolutely and I was checking I don't have time this time but I was checking on the day tour options around Brisbane and I have found some really good spots to go maybe save this for next time.

Yes there's some beautiful places very accessible from Brisbane. Brisbane itself is just wonderful and then and you have the Golden Sunshine Coast just an hour away north and south. Now tell us a bit about Tours for Fun and it's Tours the number four fun tell us about the company.

Sure yes the Tours for Fun has been on the market for over 22 years now and we are based in Los Angeles and we are specialized in selling multi-day tours and we work with the global travelers you know you name it like Intrepid, Jet Adventures, the TTC group and we serve global travelers. We are really good at selling to Asian American market so about 50% of our market are actually based in the US and selling to Chinese Americans, Indian Americans, Filipino so we found that niche market were really good at selling to that particular market. However Asia, Asian Pacific market is about 25% of what we serve so that group of travelers are growing so that's why I'm here in Australia I want to get to know more about this source market and figure out you know how can we serve this market better.

And what's your background Ting Ting, how did you get into this area? Well yeah that's gonna be a long story. When I was 16 years old I did not go to high school and I went to a trade school. Somehow I picked tourism as my major at 16 years old and then right after that I worked at a hotel as a waitress for my internship then went to learn English and then somehow find my way went to the US as an au pair and then from there from the au pair I served as the after that worked at a startup as a co-rep from a co-rep to customer service manager to general manager to co-founder of that you know in that space and then four years ago I graduated with my master's in international business and policy so what I'm passionate about is my background was 22 years growing up in China and then 16 years in the US.

How can I combine those two different uniqueness on the cultural background and then somehow I find my way to Touristful Fun. I think travel is an amazing industry you know we're building bridges here we're bringing people from Asia and going to travel in the US bring the US customers travel to Asia Asia right we're building a bridge to make the travelers all over the world get to know each other better and I believe only when we know the people better from a different cultural background right we're a more connected world especially in the world right now so many craziness happening and I just feel happy to be able to be the bridge and then build up this bridge and then you know helping people to travel around the world. Now what are some of your favorites travel experiences that you've done recently I suppose you with Touristful Fun you you get to go all around the world what what are some of the standout travel experiences? I will say that it will be China.

I grew up in China but every time I go back to China it always amazed and I I am always amazed whenever I go back to China you know how friendly the people are especially when you traveled around the world and go back to where you grew up that experience always made me feel like I am fortunate I'm very lucky to be part of growing up in China and especially recently I have seen how China as a very friendly destination welcoming the global travelers yeah my most recent was taking my parents to a city called Qingdao which is not too far from my hometown but it was able to show my parents a city that's so close to my hometown but we never went and then it was amazing we had a amazing seafood there and get to hang out with friends in that city and just spend time with my parents and my two kids it was a really nice experience I love to travel with family so that's another you know thing that we have on tours will find that how to make the family travel more convenient to the families now the technology in China is just incredible isn't it the way it's actually leapt ahead and I've spoken to quite a few people from Australia and they described China as being 20 years in the future stepping into 20 years in the future yes exactly one thing it's very interesting is that when we talk about the u.s. everybody everybody thinks that u.s. has the best technology in the world right I think u.s. does have a very good technology however when it comes to daily life right when the technology applying to daily life China is so advanced whenever I go back to China I don't have to carry my wallet right just my phone and one app you can solve all your problems you can one app takes care of everything right so one app is called a WeChat you probably do you have that on your I haven't yet but I'll look into that so with WeChat right we have a the chat right so you can talk to your friends you can share moments and then the payment and you can call the taxi from the the app and then everything all included in one app as long as you have that app you don't need to go to different apps to do different things well that's a good thing so if people going to China just get the WeChat app before you go and they'll be pretty set up yes yes yes that's for sure and there are other things more advanced if you take the train the train are much faster in China the speedy train compared with the ones in Europe and in the US right you get the very different experiences and tours for fun and we will say it reiterated tours the number for fun yes that not not tours for but tours for fun the numeral I suppose you get to travel around the world with them as well I think I probably

traveled over maybe 20 30 countries with the company I joined the company about four years ago so it's being a journey I one of my I think favorite spot to travel with the co-workers is Paris earlier at the session there was one at Janelle right Janelle was recommended us to close our eyes to think of a moment that your favorite travel spots and then when I close my eyes I was thinking actually a moment where I was traveling with my co-workers to Paris and we were under the Eiffel Tower the light started blinking right that was when I realized wow you know that was my first time in Paris first time see the Eiffel Tower it wasn't with my significant half with my co-workers but it was really special you know a really special moment that made me feel this is a job right it's not just a job that you go to work and you get paid it's a experience you actually get to experience something amazing in life so I think everybody who's in this travel industry but we are really lucky to be in this industry because we're in the experience industry that travel is part of what do we do every day and we get to help people to create those moments so that always make me very excited yeah yes we're speaking with Tingting Jiao from Tours for Fun on Travel Radio Australia and Tingting how can people find out more about Tours for Fun online? Sure you can go to our official website right and Tours for Fun as far as number four however if you speak Chinese we have a Chinese website it's a Tours for Fun the four is actually so both website works we have about a hundred fifty team members around the world serving global travelers so if you have questions feel free to get in touch with one of us and we're always happy to help you to get on your next amazing journey. And Tingting can you say something in Mandarin for our Travel Radio Australia audience? Absolutely thank you Geoffrey Thank you very much and thank you for being on the program. Thank you Geoffrey such a great honor to be here